



Lost all MS Office data. Windows doesn't load. Deleted the only XP user account... Hang on, don't press the panic button. Here's your way out

Files will be back

Q. I have a Celeron 1.7 GHz with a 40 GB hard disk. After I ran disk defragmenter, I lost all my MS Office documents (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, etc). I even lost data on my D and E drives. How do I retrieve all my lost data?

Pankaj Singhai

A Use R-Studio (www.r-tt.com)—it's one of the best data recovery software available. Ideally, load R-Studio onto another PC, connect your hard drive to it (preferably as a slave) and then restore data.

Note that once you detect the data loss, do not install, copy or move software or data on the drives in question, and keep disk activity at a minimum, so that lost files don't get overwritten.

Also, be very careful when recovering data; don't recover any data onto your

hard drive itself—instead, recover the data to the other PC you're connecting your hard drive to. Once that is done, copy all the recovered data back.

Error loading Gdi.exe

Q. I recently installed Windows 98 Second Edition. My computer is an Intel Pentium III, 256 MB SD RAM, and a 20 GB Seagate hard drive. Whenever I switch on my machine, it automatically boots into Safe Mode. Then I get a message that says, "Error Loading Gdi.exe. You Must Reinstall Windows" and the computer shuts off automatically. How do I fix this?

Abhijit Mukherjee

A The error appears as a result of either improperly moving the Fonts folder of Windows or by corruption of some font files. The simplest option is to re-install Windows again.

If you don't want to re-install Windows, be prepared to execute some commands at the DOS prompt. First boot the computer via the Windows 98 CD-ROM, and select 'Windows 98 Startup disk with CD-ROM support'. Now execute the following commands one after another:

```
md c:\windows\fonts
attrib +s c:\windows\fonts
extract/a d:\win98\win98_22.cab
```

```
*.fon /I c:\windows\fonts extract /a
d:\win98\win98_22.cab *.ttf /I
c:\windows\fonts
```

Now, reboot the computer. If your Fonts folder exists, then the problem is caused by corrupt fonts, namely Vgasyf.fon, Vgaoem.fon and Vga850.fon. All you need to do is extract these files from the Windows CD-ROM, using the following commands:

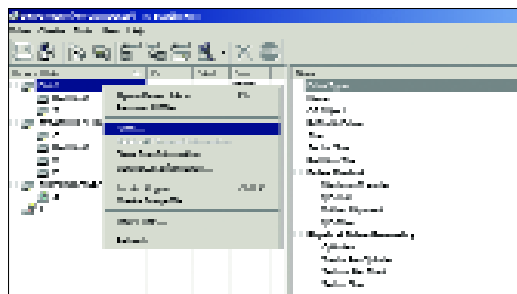
```
extract /a d:\win98\win98_22.cab vgasyf.fon
/I c:\windows\fonts
extract /a d:\win98\win98_22.cab
vgaoem.fon /I c:\windows\fonts
extract /a d:\win98\win98_22.cab
vga850.fon /I c:\windows\fonts
```

USB ports to transfer files over telephone lines

Q. I have an old computer: a Pentium 233 MMX, 32 MB of RAM and Windows 98SE, but without a USB port. The Device Manager shows two devices of the device type USB Controllers—SIS 7001 PCI to USB Open Host Controller and USB Root Hub. First, what are these? Second, using these can I install a USB port? If yes, how? And finally, is it possible to create a network between two computers using their modems and a telephone cable?

Arun Das

A The two devices you mention are USB controllers. This means your moth-



Right-click on the additional drive and click scan to start the process